

Iris Thijs

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EDUCATION

University of Cambridge | *Master of Engineering in Computer Science* 2013 - 2017

- Achieved First Class Honours with distinction; authored thesis on distributed consensus algorithms adopted by 3 academic institutions
- Led college programming society with 200+ members, organizing 12 annual coding competitions and workshops

ETH Zurich | *Exchange Programme - Advanced Systems Design* 2015 - 2016

- Completed specialized coursework in microservices architecture and concurrent systems programming
- Collaborated on research project that resulted in 1 peer-reviewed publication in distributed computing journal

EXPERIENCE

Stripe | *Staff Backend Engineer* 2022 - Present

- Architected and led migration of core payment processing service from monolith to event-driven microservices, reducing latency by 34% and enabling 8 new revenue streams generating \$2.1M annually
- Designed payment reconciliation system processing 150M+ transactions daily; achieved 99.99% accuracy and reduced financial discrepancies by 87%
- Mentored 6 senior engineers and established backend engineering practices adopted across 40-person team, improving code review turnaround by 42%

Datadog | *Senior Staff Backend Engineer* 2019 - 2022

- Engineered high-throughput metrics aggregation pipeline handling 5.2 trillion data points/month; optimized storage utilization by 56% saving \$3.8M annually
- Led incident response infrastructure overhaul; introduced distributed tracing for 600+ microservices, reducing mean time to resolution by 63%
- Built and open-sourced Lua-based service mesh configuration framework adopted by 12+ companies; garnered 2.4K GitHub stars

Cloudflare | *Senior Backend Engineer* 2017 - 2019

- Optimized DNS query resolution engine using Rust, reducing query latency from 145ms to 18ms (87.6% improvement) across 200+ data centers globally
- Developed distributed rate-limiting system protecting 8 million domains from DDoS attacks; prevented \$47M in potential customer outages
- Established performance benchmarking framework that identified 23 critical bottlenecks in authentication services, collectively improving throughput by 2.9x

Shopify | *Backend Engineer* 2015 - 2017

- Built order fulfillment microservice handling 12M+ orders monthly; implemented caching strategy reducing database load by 71%
- Designed and deployed payment gateway abstraction layer supporting 7 new payment providers, increasing merchant conversion by 18%

PROJECTS

Kronos - Distributed Task Scheduler | *Go, gRPC, PostgreSQL, Redis, Kubernetes* 2021 - 2023

- Architected fault-tolerant distributed task scheduler supporting 500K concurrent jobs with 99.95% reliability; reduced scheduling latency by 73% compared to existing solutions
- Implemented adaptive backpressure mechanism automatically scaling across 8 Kubernetes clusters; decreased resource utilization by 42% while maintaining SLA guarantees

VectorFlow - ML Training Data Pipeline | *Python, Apache Spark, Kafka, BigQuery* 2020 - 2021

- Created streaming data pipeline processing 280K events/second for ML feature generation; achieved 99.7% data completeness and reduced pipeline errors by 89%
- Implemented intelligent partitioning algorithm reducing training data shuffle time by 64%, enabling 4.2x faster model iteration cycles

EXTRACURRICULAR

Backend Architecture Summit | *Conference Speaker & Track Organizer* 2021 - Present

- Delivered keynote on scaling distributed systems to 1,200+ engineers; presentation ranked #2 most impactful with 94% positive feedback rating
- Organized distributed systems track featuring 18 sessions; curated talks that drove 34% increase in conference attendance year-over-year

CNCF Mentorship Program | *Mentor* 2020 - Present

- Mentored 8 junior engineers in Kubernetes and cloud-native development; 6 protégés secured positions at tier-1 tech companies within 12 months
- Created comprehensive backend system design curriculum adopted by 3 universities in open-source education initiative

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages – Go, Python, Rust, Java, TypeScript, SQL

Technologies – gRPC, GraphQL, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Kubernetes, Docker, Apache Spark, Protocol Buffers, Pub/Sub systems

Tools – Git, GitHub, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, CircleCI), DataDog, Prometheus, ELK Stack, Terraform, AWS, GCP